Reading ABGs with ROME

Adult Health | General

REMEMBER IT AS

Respiratory Opposite, Metabolic Equal

- **Respiratory Opposite**
  pH and PaCO2 move in opposite directions (pH down, CO2 up = respiratory acidosis).
- **Metabolic Equal**
  pH and HCO3 move in the same direction (pH down, HCO3 down = metabolic acidosis).
- **Normal ranges**
  pH 7.35-7.45, PaCO2 35-45 mm Hg, HCO3 22-26 mEq/L.

NURSE TIP

Look at pH first, then decide which value (CO2 or HCO3) explains it.